KALE REALTY

STEERING BUYERS INTO YOUR OWN LISTINGS ISN'T MARKETING.

It's dual agency, and Illinois has rules for that.

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IF EVERY HOME YOU SEND A BUYER IS ONE YOU ALSO REPRESENT, THAT'S NOT THE MARKET.

That's a shortlist built around who pays you.

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THE FIX IS RUNNING THE CLIENT'S SEARCH, NOT YOUR OWN INVENTORY.

Under the Illinois Real Estate License Act, 225 ILCS 454/15-45, a licensee can only act as a dual agent with the informed written consent of every client, confirmed in writing no later than when a contract is entered. Funnel a buyer toward listings you or your brokerage hold, or ones paying a richer co-op, without that consent, and the self-steering is the problem. "Better fit" quietly became "better commission," and nobody signed off on it.

RUN EVERY BUYER SEARCH LIKE THIS:

1 **Search the client's criteria, not your own inventory.**
Every listing that fits ships to the buyer, whoever holds it and whatever it pays you.

2 **Say it out loud when you show your own.**
Name the conflict and tell them they can get separate representation.

3 **Put the consent in writing before it matters.**
Illinois requires it in writing, not a verbal heads-up, and no later than when a contract is signed.

THE TAKEAWAY

FIT DECIDES THE SHORTLIST. NOT WHO PAYS YOU.

A buyer who figures that out later doesn't call you for the next house.

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